TEACHER GUIDE

AQA A-level Business (7138)

Leadership and management

3.2 Unit: Managing people and operations
3.2.1 People management: leadership



A revision lesson. Pupils run a car dealership in firms of four and revise leadership and management on their own deals. Seat each firm together. Each firm answers the topic tasks together.

The lesson

45-minute setting

Setup	Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Final questions

EVERY ROUND

Firm decisions
3 min

→

Deals
4½–5 min

→

Topic tasks
4 min

→

B2B deal
2½ min
from Round 2

LESSON SETTINGS

30 min	**45 min**	60 min	75 min

What pupils do

Every pupil buys and sells cars. In Firm decisions, each role has its own job.



CEO

Staff · Sabotage from Round 2



Finance

Capital & Loans · Investments



Sales & Marketing

Marketing



Operations

Seasonal stock

Topic tasks

Each firm gets its own figures. The method is the same.

1 Name the style

Round 1

The manager makes every decision alone and tells staff what to do.

Which leadership style is this?

- **A** None: there is no leader
- **B** Autocratic: the leader decides
- **C** Democratic: the team decides
- **D** Transformational: a shared vision

ANSWER

✓ Autocratic: the leader decides

Why: One person deciding and giving orders is autocratic leadership.

2 Autocratic effects

Round 1

A manager decides everything alone and gives orders.

Which two effects are most likely over time?

- **A** Decisions take longer
- **B** Fast decisions in a crisis
- **C** Staff feel more involved
- **D** Staff gain more responsibility
- **E** Skilled staff feel undervalued

ANSWER

✓ Fast decisions in a crisis
✓ Skilled staff feel undervalued

Why: Deciding alone is quick, but skilled staff want a say.

3 Rank sales rise

Round 2

Three teams: sales a month before and after a new leader.

Order by the rise in sales, largest % first?

- **A** 30 to 33 sales
- **B** 50 to 60 sales
- **C** 80 to 92 sales

ANSWER

1. 50 to 60 sales
2. 80 to 92 sales
3. 30 to 33 sales

Why: Rises of 20%, 15% and 10%: the biggest team did not improve most.

Topic tasks

4 Cost of a meeting

Round 2

The manager asks the whole team.

Wage cost of the meeting?

Sales staff at the meeting	**8 staff**
Each one's pay an hour	**£16**
Manager's pay an hour	**£34**
Meeting length	**3 hours**

ANSWER

£486

3 × (8 × £16 + £34) = £486

Why: Asking the team wins support, but its time has a cost.

5 New team, deadline

Round 3

A new, untrained team must deliver a big fleet order by Friday.

Which approach fits, and why?

A Clear instructions from the manager

B Let the team decide how

ANSWER

✓ Clear instructions from the manager

Why: Untrained staff and little time need clear direction.

6 Bold plan, coaching

Round 3

Staff do the minimum. A new manager shares a bold plan and coaches each one to reach it.

Which style is this, and why?

A Autocratic: decides alone

B Transformational: inspires change

C None: it is only management

D Democratic: staff vote on it

ANSWER

✓ Transformational: inspires change

Why: A shared vision and coaching that change how staff work is transformational.

Final questions

Each pupil answers 6 final questions on leadership and management. They come from these 8 questions.

1. A dealer says managers welcome challenge, but staff say every failed decision is punished. Which cultural effect is most likely?
   ✔ **Staff stop raising risks or new ideas**

2. A safety incident at a branch needs immediate coordinated action. Why might a usually participative leader become more directive for now?
   ✔ **Urgent risk needs fast, clear decisions**

3. A workshop foreman decides every job allocation himself and tells technicians exactly how to do each task. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Autocratic**

4. Before changing opening hours, a sales manager asks the team for views and lets them vote. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Democratic**

5. Experienced technicians set their own hours and methods; the manager steps in only when asked. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Laissez-faire**

6. A brake fault is found on cars in the showroom. Why might an autocratic style suit the next hour?
   ✔ **Fast, clear instructions are needed**

7. An owner decides everything herself but explains each decision and looks after staff welfare. Which leadership style is this?
   ✔ **Paternalistic**

8. What is a main drawback of democratic leadership in a busy dealership?
   ✔ **Decisions can take longer**